

BESPOKE Made to order and custom-tailored for an individual; see also *Tailor-made*.

19TH CENTURY ▷

BIAS The diagonal across the *grain* of a fabric, at 45 degrees to the *warp* and *weft*; cutting on the bias can enable a garment to stretch.

MEDIEVAL ▷: SEE P.446

BICORN A wide-brimmed hat with the brim turned up at the front and back, often with a slight peak at the front and adorned with a rosette or cockade.

18TH–EARLY 19TH CENTURY

BIKINI Two-piece women's bathing suit resembling a *brassière* and knickers, invented in 1946 by French engineer Louis Réard.

1946 ▷: SEE PP.336–7

BISHOP SLEEVE In women's garments, a sleeve made from light fabrics, widening from the shoulder and gathered into a *cuff* at the wrist.

19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.196–7, 241, 458

BLACKWORK Embroidery worked in black *silk* thread to form geometric or scrolled designs, often used on collars and *cuffs*.

c.1510–1630s: SEE P.109

BLANKET CLOTH Heavy *woollen* cloth with a raised finish, commonly used for overcoats.

19TH CENTURY

BLAZER Originally a man's *jacket* for boating, now a classic semi-formal *jacket*, widely used in school or adult uniforms.

1890s ▷: SEE PP.217, 283–4, 448

BLOCK PRINTING Method of printing fabric, in which one or more colours are applied to fabric using carved wooden blocks, each colour needing a separate block.

BLOOMERS Baggy *knickerbockers* worn by women for cycling and other sports; also loose, knee-length women's underpants; invented and named after Mrs Amelia Bloomer.

1851–MID-20TH CENTURY: SEE P.215

BLOUSE A *smock*-like cotton or linen garment originally worn by working men, or a light, soft shirt for women; can also refer to the upper part of military *battledress*.

EARLY 19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE P.241

BLOUSON A short, loose-fitting men's *jacket* with elasticated or drawstring hem and *cuffs*, used in sports, military, and casual wear; see also *Bomber jacket*.

1950s ▷

BOA A long, round-ended *tippet* made of feathers or fur.

19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.178, 291

BOATER Stiff straw hat with flat-topped crown, straight brim, and hat-band of *Petersham ribbon*, for casual summerwear.

19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.211, 214–17

BOAT NECK See *Bateau neck*.

BOBBIN LACE An openwork fabric made by plaiting and twisting together a number of threads held on bobbins.

BODICE The upper part of a garment, especially a dress, between the shoulders and the waist.

15TH CENTURY ▷: SEE P.139

BODIES, PAIR OF An under-bodice of two parts joined at the sides, padded, and stiffened with *whalebone*, wood, or steel.

16TH–17TH CENTURY: SEE P.98

BODKIN Formerly a long, ornate hair pin; today refers to a blunt needle used for threading ribbon, tape, or elastic through a *casing*.

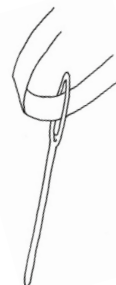
16TH CENTURY ▷

BODY COAT Tailors' term for the coat part of a suit, as distinct from an *overcoat* or *top coat*.

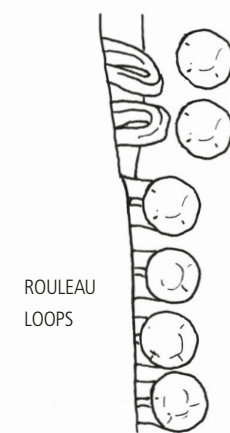
19TH CENTURY ▷

BODY STOCKING A stretchy body covering like a *leotard*, but also covering the legs to the ankles.

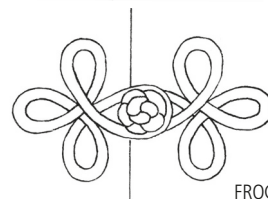
MID-1960s ▷



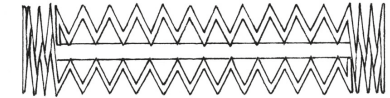
BUTTONHOLES



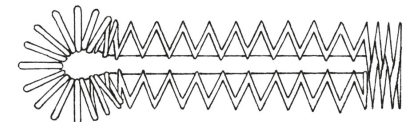
ROULEAU
LOOPS



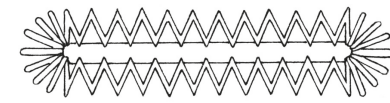
FROG



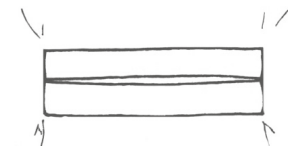
PLAIN BUTTONHOLE



KEYHOLE BUTTONHOLE



ROUND-END BUTTONHOLE



BOUND BUTTONHOLE

BOLERO A very short-cropped, decorative, open *jacket* for women, often worn with a dress; inspired by traditional Spanish men's *jackets*.

MID-19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.273, 335, 396

BOLO TIE Also known as a bootlace or shoestring tie, a very narrow necktie comprising a length of cord or braided leather with decorative metal *aglets* and secured with an ornamental clasp or slide; worn as part of *cowboy style* or *Teddy-boy style*.

1940s ▷

BOLT Industry standard unit in which rolled cloth is manufactured and supplied, comprising a specific length and/or width.

BOMBACHAS Baggy trousers gathered at the ankle, worn for horseback riding in Argentina and Uruguay.

EARLY 19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE P.441

BOMBAST Fibrous material such as *cotton*, horsehair, *wool*, or rags, used to pad out parts of a garment such as the *trunk-hose* or sleeves.

SEE P.105

BOMBAZINE *Twilled* fabric with a *silk warp* and *worsted weft*, first used undyed and later dyed black and used for mourning apparel.

16TH–20TH CENTURY

BOMBER JACKET *Blouson*, usually leather, originally worn by US Air Force crews, now generally adopted as casual wear.

1940s ▷

BONDAGE STYLE A style associated with punk and other youth cultures, featuring clothes embellished with straps, chains, and studs.

LATE 1970s ▷: SEE P.404

BONGRACE A flat, rectangular, stiffened head covering extending over the forehead at the front and down to the shoulders at the back; also refers to part of a *French hood*.

16TH–EARLY

17TH CENTURY

